



BRAND GUIDE · V1.0

AI suggests. Sources show. *You decide.*

How SELAR looks, sounds and behaves: logo, Linny the mascot, colour, type, voice and the claims we can and can't make.



A careful, cheerful study companion

SELAR is a research prototype PDF reader. While you read, it suggests a possible link to something you read earlier, puts both passages side by side, and asks you to explain, compare and decide. Grounded in learning research on depth of processing, self-explanation, comparison and retrieval practice.

The brand should make that loop feel friendly and low-stakes, while staying honest: SELAR is early, the AI can be wrong, and the reader is the one doing the thinking.

Personality

Curious, not clever-clever · **Warm**, not cutesy

Honest, not hedging · **Tidy**, not corporate



1

Read

Open your PDFs and read as usual.

2

Notice

SELAR suggests a possible link to something you read earlier.

3

Compare

Both source passages appear side by side, so you can check the link yourself.

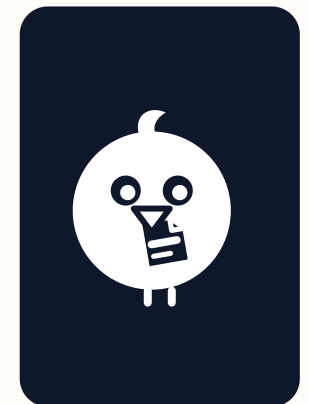
4

Explain & decide

Say how they connect in your own words, then keep, change or reject the link.

Linny holding a page

The mark is Linny the linnet bringing back a page from earlier reading. The wordmark is lowercase **selar** in Fraunces (soft, weight 650) outlined to paths, so it never depends on installed fonts.

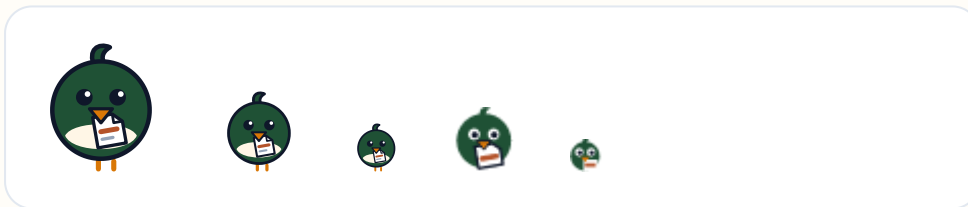


Horizontal lockup (default) · on dark · icon · lockup with descriptor · stacked · mono ink · mono white. Files: **logo/svg** and **logo/png**.

Give it room



Dashed line: minimum clear space. Hatched area: keep free of text and graphics.



Left to right: 64, 40 and 24 px mark, then the simplified 32 and 16 px favicon drawings (actual size).

Clear space

Keep empty space around the logo at least the height of the page in Linny's beak (about a quarter of the icon height) on every side.

Minimum size

Icon 24 px on screen / 8 mm in print. Below 24 px use the simplified favicon drawing. Horizontal lockup at least 120 px / 30 mm wide.

Backgrounds

Colour logo on mist, paper or white. On-dark version on forest or ink. Mono versions on photos and one-colour print.

Alternatives

Directions B (Page Bridge) and C (Knot S) are kept in exploration/. Switch as a whole system, never mix marks.

DON'T

- × Stretch, squash or rotate the logo
- × Recolour outside the palette or add gradients
- × Put the colour mark on busy photos
- × Retype the wordmark in another font
- × Add shadows, outlines or glows
- × Separate Linny from the page in the logo

Forest, ink and a rust-red thread

Carried over from the illustrated presentation deck. Paper and Sun add warmth; Rust ink keeps small text accessible on tints.

Forest #1F5135 RGB 31, 81, 53 Primary. Linny, buttons, dark surfaces	Moss #5B8A6F RGB 91, 138, 111 Illustration fills, wing, charts	Ink #0F172A RGB 15, 23, 42 Text and outlines	Slate #475569 RGB 71, 85, 105 Secondary text	Rust #B4532A RGB 180, 83, 42 The thread: links, focus	Rust ink #9A4322 RGB 154, 67, 34 Small rust text on tints
Amber #D97706 RGB 217, 119, 6 Beak, feet, badges (ink text)	Sun #F6C453 RGB 246, 196, 83 Decorative sparkle only	Mist #F1F5F9 RGB 241, 245, 249 App background	Paper #FFFDF8 RGB 255, 253, 248 Reading surface, print	Sky #E1EDFB RGB 225, 237, 251 Info callouts, blobs	Blush #FBEDE6 RGB 251, 237, 230 Prototype pill, gentle notes

Rough proportions on a typical surface



Contrast pairs (WCAG 2.2)

Sample	Text / background	Ratio	Use
Aa Ink on Mist	#0F172A / #F1F5F9	16.30:1	AA all text
Aa Slate on White	#475569 / #FFFFFF	7.58:1	AA all text
Aa Slate on Mist	#475569 / #F1F5F9	6.92:1	AA all text
Aa White on Forest	#FFFFFF / #1F5135	9.18:1	AA all text
Aa Paper on Forest	#FFFDF8 / #1F5135	9.03:1	AA all text
Aa Rust on White	#B4532A / #FFFFFF	4.99:1	AA all text
Aa Rust ink on Blush	#9A4322 / #FBEDE6	5.74:1	AA all text
Aa Ink on Sky	#0F172A / #E1EDFB	15.05:1	AA all text
Aa Ink on Amber	#0F172A / #D97706	5.60:1	AA all text
Aa White on Moss	#FFFFFF / #5B8A6F	3.95:1	AA large text only
Aa Rust on Blush	#B4532A / #FBEDE6	4.36:1	AA large text only
Aa Amber on White	#D97706 / #FFFFFF	3.19:1	AA large text only

Rules of thumb

- Body text: ink or slate on mist, paper or white.
- Small rust text on blush uses **rust ink** (#9A4322).
- White on moss and amber on white are for large text or graphics only.
- Sun and amber are never text colours on light backgrounds.
- Don't rely on colour alone: kept / changed / rejected links also get an icon and a word.

Ratios computed from relative luminance; DESIGN.md is linted with @google/design.md (0 errors, 0 warnings).

Fraunces for voice, Figtree for reading

DISPLAY · FRAUNCES, SOFT 100, 650–700

Every new page
has an old friend.

Aa Bb Cc 0123456789 “link” & ?!

UI & BODY · FIGTREE 400 / 700

Spotted a possible link to your notes on working
memory. Both passages are below. How do they
connect?

Body 16 px / 1.55 · small 14 px · labels 12 px bold, tracked
0.08em, uppercase.

JetBrains Mono · p. 14 · doc_7f2a · sim 0.82

● RESEARCH PROTOTYPE

Keep link

Font	Role	Licence	Source
Fraunces (variable: opsz, wght, SOFT, WONK)	Headlines, wordmark, numbers	SIL OFL 1.1	github.com/google/fonts/tree/main/ofl/fraunces
Figtree (variable: wght)	Body, UI, captions	SIL OFL 1.1	github.com/google/fonts/tree/main/ofl/figtree
JetBrains Mono	Page refs, IDs, debug	SIL OFL 1.1	github.com/google/fonts/tree/main/ofl/jetbrainsmono

Meet Linny the linnet

Linnets are small, chatty finches. Linny carries pages between what you read now and what you read before, then waits for your call. Linny suggests and asks; Linny never grades, scolds or claims to know best.



hello
Hello / onboarding



reading
Reading



linking
Linking two passages



thinking
Thinking / loading



celebrating
Kept a link



questioning
Questioning a weak link



empty
Nothing yet (empty state)

DO

Use one Linny per view, at the moment it helps: onboarding, loading, a new suggestion, an empty library, a kept link.

DO

Use *questioning* for weak or rejected links. Rejecting a stretch is good thinking, so keep it gentle.

DON'T

Put Linny over text, on warnings about data or errors, or in academic figures and the report.

Talk like a good study partner

Plain, kind and specific. Ask rather than tell. Name the source. Admit uncertainty without drowning in it. One light joke is fine; three is a lot.

SAY

Spotted a possible link to Chapter 2.
Does it hold?

NOT

We found the perfect connection for you!

SAY

SELAR is a research prototype.
Feedback welcome.

NOT

SELAR boosts your memory by 40%.

SAY

Grounded in research on self-explanation and retrieval practice.

NOT

Scientifically proven to improve grades.

SAY

Not sure? Reject it. Weak links are worth catching.

NOT

Error: invalid link rejected.

SAY

Nothing linked yet. Read a little more and Linny will check back.

NOT

No data. Upload content to continue.

Illustration style

- Flat shapes, 3.5 px ink outline at mark scale, round caps and joins.
- Pages are rounded rectangles with a folded corner and two text lines.
- The thread is rust; dashed when a link is uncertain.
- Soft sky or blush circles behind characters. No gradients, no photos of people, no stock clip art.



What we can and can't say

- Always say "research prototype" somewhere visible.
- Never claim SELAR improves memory, retention, grades or learning. The retention study is planned, not run.
- You may say the design is grounded in learning research (depth of processing, self-explanation, comparison, retrieval practice).
- Quote the survey only as: 38 eligible respondents; 31/36 wanted linking; 28/36 worried about AI accuracy; 24/36 worried about less active thinking.
- No testimonials, user counts, partner logos, prices or incentives.
- Do not promise anything about a study (participation, payment, results) until ethics approval is confirmed.

Survey numbers, exactly

Formative needs survey, 38 eligible respondents; 36 answered these items. Not an evaluation of SELAR.

31 of 36 wanted a tool that links new reading to earlier reading

28 of 36 were concerned about AI accuracy

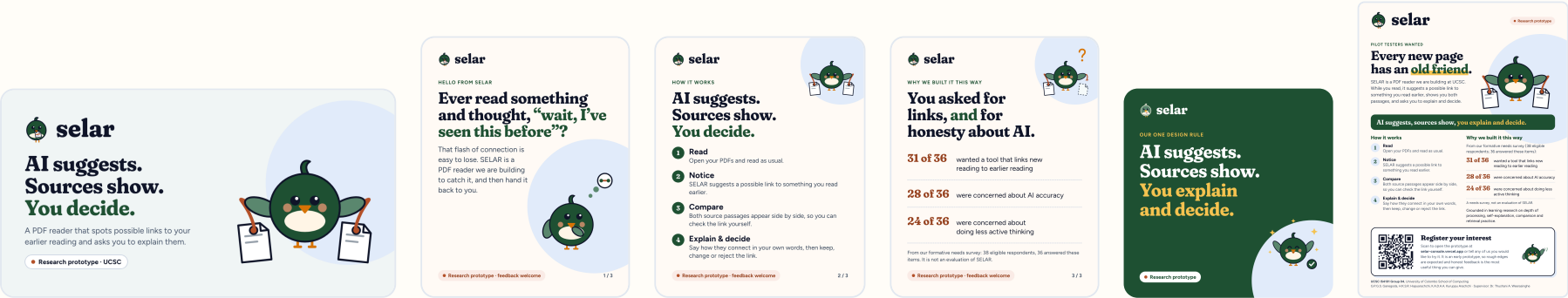
24 of 36 were concerned about doing less active thinking

Recommended tagline

AI suggests. Sources show. You decide.

Files and where they go

Folder	Contents
logo/svg, logo/png	Lockup (horizontal, descriptor, stacked), icon and wordmark in colour, on-dark, mono ink and mono white. PNG at 512/1024/2048 px.
favicon/	favicon.ico (16/32/48), favicon-16/32/48, apple-touch-icon 180, icon-192/512, maskable 512, favicon.svg, site.webmanifest.
mascot/	Linny in 7 poses, SVG and PNG.
exploration/	All three directions (A Linny, B Page Bridge, C Knot S) with icons and lockups, plus the comparison board.
social/	OG/Twitter card 1200×630, 3-slide carousel 1080×1350, 2 squares 1080×1080, captions (drafts, not posted).
print/	A4 "try the prototype" flyer, PDF and PNG.
DESIGN.md, tokens.dtcg.json, theme.css	Machine-readable tokens (Google DESIGN.md spec), DTCG and Tailwind v4 exports.
Console code	components/brand/Logo.tsx (Logo, LogoMark, Wordmark) and Linny.tsx (pose prop) in services/selar-console.



All artwork is original, drawn as code (SVG) by the team's tooling. Fonts are SIL OFL. Sources and build scripts: brand/tools in the selar-dev repo.